at slip when I'd made 193. Nick went on to score 221, and, with Simon Harmer taking fourteen wickets, we won a rain-affected match by an innings with two minutes to spare.

In psychological terms, I was colour-coded as a 'cool blue', a so-called introverted thinker. I was depicted as being very analytical and had to be aware of the danger of overthinking, when the tendency was to become too mechanistic in my batting. In another simple metaphor, used by Mark Bawden, England's psychologist, I was characterized as an 'assassin'. My strength was my ability to stay within my bubble and utilize repeatable skill.

So, in tennis terms, I was Bjorn Borg. KP was John McEnroe, a 'yellow' and extroverted 'feeler'. He had a 'warrior' mentality, emotional and aggressive. Players can switch between the modes, as in the case of a confrontational fast bowler like Stuart Broad having occasionally to think a batsman out, but the common denominator is the development of the ability to remain in the moment.

Scoring a hundred is almost arbitrary. You play as well to get to 99 as you do to get to 101. It means little in the run of the game, but everything, psychologically and practically, to the batsman. In our enclosed, statistically driven world, you are judged on centuries, not near misses. I was once told no England player has scored more nineties, but to be honest, it is such an arcane record I haven't bothered to check. It's probably true, because I have played more games than anyone else.

Would it change things? Obviously not, and that's one of the stupid things about cricket. The only time I felt I messed up unforgivably in such circumstances was against Australia at Lord's in 2015 when I attempted a big drive and played on to the leg stump, off the inside edge, to Mitch Marsh when I'd made 96. It was a schoolboy error, a submission to the situation.

I was spewing about it because I allowed myself to be undone by the proximity of the second new ball. I wanted my century as insurance against a delivery with my name on it. If I had played the same way as I had for the previous six hours I would have achieved it, but I succumbed to outside influence rather than backing myself.

It was a terrible mental mistake, at a critical juncture. You didn't want to be inside my head in the endless seconds when I slumped forward on one knee in disbelief at what I had done and stared at the ground as if inviting it